

Getting Started with Dart



Dart is an open source Web programming language that has been rolled out by Google. It is scalable, and has robust libraries and runtimes for building Web, server and mobile apps. Touted as a rival to JavaScript, it was created out of the frustrations a few developers had with some aspects of the 20-year old language. Dart holds great promise for the future.

Dart is an open source, scalable programming language, maintained by Google. It's relatively easy-to-learn and can be used for building Web, server and mobile applications. It's not only just a new programming language but also a powerful new platform for modern Web development.

Dart enforces a structured design for programs, which other client-side programming languages like JavaScript don't do. Dart reduces most of the problematic issues with JavaScript such as the tendency towards sloppy, hard-to-maintain code.

JavaScript doesn't come with features like class hierarchy and inheritance, which makes the programming of large projects difficult. Dart solves this issue. Native Dart is twice as fast as JavaScript and can also be compiled back to JavaScript for any modern browser to run. It comes with a huge collection of built-in libraries and a packaging system. Using Dart, you can quickly write prototypes that evolve rapidly, and you also have access to advanced tools, reliable libraries and good software engineering techniques.

Getting started

To get started with learning Dart, <http://www.dartlang.org> provides an interactive Dartboard, which lets us write and run Dart code in the browser itself. The website also offers the Dart Editor, a downloadable text editor which lets us create, modify and run Dart apps on local machines. An SDK, which includes various command line tools and the Dart VM, can also be downloaded.

If the browser doesn't support an embedded Dart VM, you can use the built-in Dart-to-JavaScript compiler that comes with the Dart SDK to compile Dart code into JavaScript.

Dart is designed for mass adoption, so it has to have a familiar feel for both scripting language users (such as JavaScript users) and structured language users (such as Java developers).

Let's now write a simple Dart program.

Don't forget to go through the programming paradigms of Dart at <https://www.dartlang.org/docs/dart-up-and-running/ch02.html#important-concepts>.